

Reflective Summary Internship at Askari Bank IT HUB

My six-week onsite experience at the Askari Bank IT Hub was both an immersive and highly formative experience, and presented a unique view into how the enterprise IT systems within a real-world banking setting work. On the first day, I was already engaged in monitoring network domains, user accounts administration using Active directory, observing the firewall and antivirus activities and hardware troubleshooting within several branches. The assignments offered a good insight into the importance of theoretical knowledge acquired during my courses in Computer Networks and Operating Systems and how they are applied to actual IT activities. Together with Sir Raja Kashif Siddique, I was also taught how to interact with a highly sensitive security system and the need to maintain high quality and accuracy in their operations logs and document system configurations, as well as complying with the no-screenshot policies of the bank, which only supported the value of being accurate and accountable in a high stakes environment.

During the internship, I observed the intricacies of the management of an IT infrastructure of an enterprise. Setting up an outlook to support the secure communications, verifying the backups in the branches, aiding with the patch implementations and helping with incident response activities exposed me to the importance of IT in ensuring continuity of banking services. These duties enhanced my knowledge on operational continuity, cybersecurity awareness and system management at an enterprise level.

Additionally, I completed frontend web development projects linked to IT operations. I initially developed a simple user interface considering usability and layout, then refined it to ensure design consistency, responsiveness, and user-friendliness. I also prepared a detailed Software Requirements Specification (SRS) document, which taught me formal requirement analysis, documentation practices, and aligning technical development with business objectives. These assignments strengthened my technical skills while integrating software development knowledge with enterprise IT operations.

This internship was directly aligned with my academic and career goals. Networking principles, operating system diagnostics, and software engineering concepts were applied in real-time scenarios, strengthening both my technical competence and problem-solving abilities. The combination of infrastructure management and development-oriented assignments broadened my perspective on how different IT domains collaborate within a banking environment.

The experience also highlighted areas where the internship could be further enriched. Introducing live demonstrations or controlled simulations for tasks restricted by security policies would allow interns to receive immediate feedback and deeper conceptual clarity.

In general, this internship was invaluable for both my technical growth and professional maturity. I became more confident in handling enterprise IT systems, assisting with frontend development tasks, and preparing formal software documentation. It also enhanced my skills in cybersecurity monitoring and coordinating across teams—essential for a successful career in banking IT operations

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